

# A MARRIAGE PROPOSAL

a comedy in one act

by

ANTON CHEKHOV

English version by

HILMAR BAUKHAGE

and

BARRETT H. CLARK



SAMUEL FRENCH, INC.

FAVORITE ONE-ACT PLAYS

*from*

SAMUEL FRENCH, INC.

---

THE APOLLO OF BELLAC – ARIA DA CAPO –  
THE BALD SOPRANO – BIRDBATH – THE  
BROWNING VERSION – CALM DOWN MOTHER –  
THE CHAIRS – CHAMBER MUSIC – CHINAMEN –  
COMINGS AND GOINGS – COP-OUT – DEATH –  
THE FLATTERING WORD – FUNNYHOUSE OF A  
NEGRO – THE FUTURE IS IN EGGS – THE  
GLOAMING, OH MY DARLING – GOD – THE GOLDEN  
FLEECE – HANDS ACROSS THE SEA – THE HAPPY  
JOURNEY TO CAMDEN AND TRENTON –  
HERE WE ARE – IF MEN PLAYED CARDS AS  
WOMEN DO – JACK, OR THE SUBMISSION –  
THE LESSON – THE LOVE COURSE – LUNCHTIME –  
THE MAN WITH THE FLOWER IN HIS MOUTH –  
NOT ENOUGH ROPE – OUT OF OUR FATHER'S  
HOUSE – OVERTONES – POOR AUBREY –  
THE PRIVATE EAR – THE PROBLEM – THE PUBLIC  
EYE – THE RECOGNITION SCENE FROM ANASTASIA  
– RED CARNATIONS – RIDERS TO THE SEA –  
SCHUBERT'S LAST SERENADE – THE STILL ALARM  
– STILL LIFE – THE TWELVEPOUND LOOK –  
WHITE LIARS

*For descriptions of plays, consult our Basic Catalogue of Plays.*



printed on recycled paper

# **A MARRIAGE PROPOSAL**

**a comedy in one act**

**by**

**ANTON CHEKHOV**

**English version by**

**HILMAR BAUKHAGE**

**and**

**BARRETT H. CLARK**

**SAMUEL FRENCH, INC.**

**45 West 25th Street  
7623 Sunset Blvd.  
LONDON**

**NYC 10010  
Hollywood 90046  
TORONTO**

Copyright © 1914 by Barrett H. Clark  
Copyright © 1942 (In Renewal) by Barrett H. Clark

THE WORLD'S BEST PLAYS  
BY CELEBRATED EUROPEAN AUTHORS  
BARRETT H. CLARK  
General Editor

No part of this book may be reproduced, stored in a retrieval system, or transmitted in any form, by any means, including mechanical, electronic, photocopying, recording, or otherwise, without the prior written permission of the publisher.

No one shall make any changes in this play for the purpose of production.

Publication of this play does not imply availability for performance. Both amateurs and professionals considering a production are *strongly* advised in their own interests to apply to Samuel French, Inc., for written permission before starting rehearsals, advertising, or booking a theatre.

No part of this book may be reproduced, stored in a retrieval system, or transmitted in any form, by any means, now known or yet to be invented, including mechanical, electronic, photocopying, recording, videotaping, or otherwise, without the prior written permission of the publisher.

ISBN 0 573 62898 X

Printed in U.S.A.

## ANTON TCHEKOFF

Anton Tchekoff is one of the masters of contemporary Russian literature. His plays—"The Seagull" and "The Cherry Orchard" are the best known—are considered classics in Russia, while his stories of Russian life are famous for their style, and their insight into peasant life and the peasant mind. His longer plays lack what we should call action, but their characterization, their subtle picturing of society, and their "atmosphere," entitle them to a position of high eminence.

Tchekoff wrote five or six short plays, some of them uproarious farces; among these are "The Boor" and "A Marriage Proposal." Here he shows the lighter side of Russian country life, infusing some of the spirit of the great Gogol into his broad character portrayals. In these plays he appears to be asking his audience to cast off restraint and laugh with him at the stupidity and naïveté, as well as good-heartedness, of the people he knew so well.

---

A simple interior is all that is required for the setting.



# A Marriage Proposal

## PERSONS IN THE PLAY

STEPAN STEPANOVITCH TSCHUBUKOV

*A country farmer*

NATALIA STEPANOVNA....*His daughter (aged 25)*

IVAN VASSILIYITCH LOMOV.*Tschubukov's neighbor*

SCENE: *Reception-room in TSCHUBUKOV'S country home, Russia.*

TIME: *The present.*

# A Marriage Proposal

---

SCENE: *The reception room in TSCHUBUKOV's home.*  
TSCHUBUKOV discovered as the curtain rises.

(*Enter LOMOV, wearing a dress-suit.*)

TSCHUB. (*Going toward him and greeting him*)  
Who is this I see? My dear fellow! Ivan Vasil'yitch! I'm so glad to see you! (*Shakes hands*)  
But this is a surprise! How are you?

LOMOV. Thank you! And how are you?

TSCHUB. Oh, so-so, my friend. Please sit down.  
It isn't right to forget one's neighbor. But tell me, why all this ceremony? Dress clothes, white gloves and all? Are you on your way to some engagement, my good fellow?

LOMOV. No, I have no engagement except with you, Stepan Stepanovitch.

TSCHUB. But why in evening clothes, my friend? This isn't New Year's!

LOMOV. You see, it's simply this, that—(*Composing himself*) I have come to you, Stepan Stepanovitch, to trouble you with a request. It is not the first time I have had the honor of turning to you for assistance, and you have always, that is—I beg your pardon, I am a bit excited! I'll take a drink of water first, dear Stepan Stepanovitch. (*He drinks*)

TSCHUB. (*Aside*) He's come to borrow money! I won't give him any! (*To LOMOV*) What is it, then, dear Lomov?

LOMOV. You see—dear—Stepanovitch, pardon me, Stepan—Stepan—dearvitch—I mean—I am terribly nervous, as you will be so good as to see—! What I mean to say—you are the only one who can help me, though I don't deserve it, and—and I have no right whatever to make this request of you.

TSCHUB. Oh, don't beat about the bush, my dear fellow. Tell me!

LOMOV. Immediately—in a moment. Here it is, then: I have come to ask for the hand of your daughter, Natalia Stepanovna.

TSCHUB. (*Joyfully*) Angel! Ivan Vassiliyitch! Say that once again! I didn't quite hear it!

LOMOV. I have the honor to beg—

TSCHUB. (*Interrupting*) My dear, dear man! I am so happy that everything is so—everything! (*Embraces and kisses him*) I have wanted this to happen for so long. It has been my dearest wish! (*He represses a tear*) And I have always loved you, my dear fellow, as my own son! May God give you His blessings and His grace and—I always wanted it to happen. But why am I standing here like a blockhead? I am completely dumbfounded with pleasure, completely dumbfounded. My whole being—! I'll call Natalia—

LOMOV. Dear Stepan Stepanovitch, what do you think? May I hope for Natalia Stepanovna's acceptance?

TSCHUB. Really! A fine boy like you—and you think she won't accept on the minute? Love-sick as a cat and all that—! (*He goes out, right*)

LOMOV. I'm cold. My whole body is trembling as though I was going to take my examination! But the chief thing is to settle matters! If a person meditates too much, or hesitates, or talks about it, waits for an ideal or for true love, he never gets it.



Brrr! It's cold! Natalia is an excellent house-keeper, not at all bad-looking, well educated—what more could I ask? I'm so excited my ears are roaring! (*He drinks water*) And not to marry, that won't do! In the first place, I'm thirty-five—a critical age, you might say. In the second place, I must live a well-regulated life. I have a weak heart, continual palpitation, and I am very sensitive and always getting excited. My lips begin to tremble and the pulse in my right temple throbs terribly. But the worst of all is sleep! I hardly lie down and begin to doze before something in my left side begins to pull and tug, and something begins to hammer in my left shoulder—and in my head, too! I jump up like a madman, walk about a little, lie down again, but the moment I fall asleep I have a terrible cramp in the side. And so it is all night long!

(*Enter NATALIA STEPANOVNA.*)

NATALIA. Ah! It's you. Papa said to go in: there was a dealer in there who'd come to buy something. Good afternoon, Ivan Vassiliyitch.

LOMOV. Good day, my dear Natalia Stepanovna.

NATALIA. You must pardon me for wearing my apron and this old dress: we are working to-day. Why haven't you come to see us oftener? You've not been here for so long! Sit down. (*They sit down*) Won't you have something to eat?

LOMOV. Thank you, I have just had lunch.

NATALIA. Smoke, do, there are the matches. To-day it is beautiful and only yesterday it rained so hard that the workmen couldn't do a stroke of work. How many bricks have you cut? Think of it! I was so anxious that I had the whole field mowed, and now I'm sorry I did it, because I'm afraid the hay will rot. It would have been better if I had waited.

But what on earth is this? You are in evening clothes! The latest cut! Are you on your way to a ball? And you seem to be looking better, too—really. Why are you dressed up so gorgeously?

LOMOV. (*Excited*) You see, my dear Natalia Stepanovna—it's simply this: I have decided to ask you to listen to me—of course it will be a surprise, and indeed you'll be angry, but I—(*aside*) How fearfully cold it is!

NATALIA. What is it? (*A pause*) Well?

LOMOV. I'll try to be brief. My dear Natalia Stepanovna, as you know, for many years, since my childhood, I have had the honor to know your family. My poor aunt and her husband, from whom, as you know, I inherited the estate, always had the greatest respect for your father and your poor mother. The Lomovs and the Tschubukovs have been for decades on the friendliest, indeed the closest, terms with each other, and furthermore my property, as you know, adjoins your own. If you will be so good as to remember, my meadows touch your birch woods.

NATALIA. Pardon the interruption. You said "my meadows"—but are they yours?

LOMOV. Yes, they belong to me.

NATALIA. What nonsense! The meadows belong to us—not to you!

LOMOV. No, to me! Now, my dear Natalia Stepanovna!

NATALIA. Well, that is certainly news to me. How do they belong to you?

LOMOV. How? I am speaking of the meadows lying between your birch woods and my brick-earth.

NATALIA. Yes, exactly. They belong to us.

LOMOV. No, you are mistaken, my dear Natalia Stepanovna, they belong to me.

NATALIA. Try to remember exactly, Ivan Vas-

siliyitch. Is it so long ago that you inherited them?

LOMOV. Long ago! As far back as I can remember they have always belonged to us.

NATALIA. But that isn't true! You'll pardon my saying so.

LOMOV. It is all a matter of record, my dear Natalia Stepanovna. It is true that at one time the title to the meadows was disputed, but now everyone knows they belong to me. There is no room for discussion. Be so good as to listen: my aunt's grandmother put these meadows, free from all costs, into the hands of your father's grandfather's peasants for a certain time while they were making bricks for my grandmother. These people used the meadows free of cost for about forty years, living there as they would on their own property. Later, however, when——

NATALIA. There's not a word of truth in that! My grandfather, and my great-grandfather, too, knew that their estate reached back to the swamp, so that the meadows belong to us. What further discussion can there be? I can't understand it. It is really most annoying.

LOMOV. I'll show you the papers, Natalia Stepanovna.

NATALIA. No, either you are joking, or trying to lead me into a discussion. That's not at all nice! We have owned this property for nearly three hundred years, and now all at once we hear that it doesn't belong to us. Ivan Vassiliyitch, you will pardon me, but I really can't believe my ears. So far as I am concerned, the meadows are worth very little. In all they don't contain more than five acres and they are worth only a few hundred roubles, say three hundred, but the injustice of the thing is what affects me. Say what you will, I can't bear injustice.

LOMOV. Only listen until I have finished, please! The peasants of your respected father's grandfather, as I have already had the honor to tell you, baked bricks for my grandmother. My aunt's grandmother wished to do them a favor——

NATALIA. Grandfather! Grandmother! Aunt! I know nothing about them. All I know is that the meadows belong to us, and that ends the matter.

LOMOV. No, they belong to me!

NATALIA. And if you keep on explaining it for two days, and put on five suits of evening clothes, the meadows are still ours, ours, ours! I don't want to take your property, but I refuse to give up what belongs to us!

LOMOV. Natalia Stepanovna, I don't need the meadows, I am only concerned with the principle. If you are agreeable, I beg of you, accept them as a gift from me!

NATALIA. But I can give them to you, because they belong to me! That is very peculiar, Ivan Vasil'yitch! Until now we have considered you as a good neighbor and a good friend; only last year we lent you our threshing machine so that we couldn't thresh until November, and now you treat us like thieves! You offer to give me my own land. Excuse me, but neighbors don't treat each other that way. In my opinion, it's a very low trick—to speak frankly——

LOMOV. According to you I'm a usurper, then, am I? My dear lady, I have never appropriated other people's property, and I shall permit no one to accuse me of such a thing! (*He goes quickly to the bottle and drinks water*) The meadows are mine!

NATALIA. That's not the truth! They are mine!

LOMOV. Mine!

NATALIA. Eh? I'll prove it to you! This afternoon I'll send my reapers into the meadows.

LOMOV. W—h—a—t?

NATALIA. My reapers will be there to-day!

LOMOV. And I'll chase them off!

NATALIA. If you dare!

LOMOV. The meadows are mine, you understand? Mine!

NATALIA. Really, you needn't scream so! If you want to scream and snort and rage you may do it at home, but here please keep yourself within the limits of common decency.

LOMOV. My dear lady, if it weren't that I were suffering from palpitation of the heart and hammering of the arteries in my temples, I would deal with you very differently! (*In a loud voice*) The meadows belong to me!

NATALIA. Us!

LOMOV. Me!

(*Enter TSCHUBUKOV, right.*)

TSCHUB. What's going on here? What is he yelling about?

NATALIA. Papa, please tell this gentleman to whom the meadows belong, to us or to him?

TSCHUB. (*To LOMOV*) My dear fellow, the meadows are ours.

LOMOV. But, merciful heavens, Stepan Stepanovitch, how do you make that out? You at least might be reasonable. My aunt's grandmother gave the use of the meadows free of cost to your grandfather's peasants; the peasants lived on the land for forty years and used it as their own, but later when——

TSCHUB. Permit me, my dear friend. You forget that your grandmother's peasants never paid, because there had been a lawsuit over the meadows,



and everyone knows that the meadows belong to us. You haven't looked at the map.

LOMOV. I'll prove to you that they belong to me!

TSCHUB. Don't try to prove it, my dear fellow.

LOMOV. I will!

TSCHUB. My good fellow, what are you shrieking about? You can't prove anything by yelling, you know. I don't ask for anything that belongs to you, nor do I intend to give up anything of my own. Why should I? If it has gone so far, my dear man, that you really intend to claim the meadows, I'd rather give them to the peasants than you, and I certainly shall!

LOMOV. I can't believe it! By what right can you give away property that doesn't belong to you?

TSCHUB. Really, you must allow me to decide what I am to do with my own land! I'm not accustomed, young man, to have people address me in that tone of voice. I, young man, am twice your age, and I beg you to address me respectfully.

LOMOV. No! No! You think I'm a fool! You're making fun of me! You call my property yours and then expect me to stand quietly by and talk to you like a human being. That isn't the way a good neighbor behaves, Stepan Stepanovitch! You are no neighbor, you're no better than a land-grabber. That's what you are!

TSCHUB. Wh—at? What did he say?

NATALIA. Papa, send the reapers into the meadows this minute!

TSCHUB. (*To LOMOV*) What was that you said, sir?

NATALIA. The meadows belong to us and I won't give them up! I won't give them up! I won't give them up!

LOMOV. We'll see about that! I'll prove in court that they belong to me.

TSCHUB. In court! You may sue in court, sir, if you like! Oh, I know you, you are only waiting to find an excuse to go to law! You're an intriguer, that's what you are! Your whole family were always looking for quarrels. The whole lot!

LOMOV. Kindly refrain from insulting my family. The entire race of Lomov has always been honorable! And never has one been brought to trial for embezzlement, as your dear uncle was!

TSCHUB. And the whole Lomov family were insane!

NATALIA. Every one of them!

TSCHUB. Your grandmother was a dipsomaniac, and the younger aunt, Nastasia Michailovna, ran off with an architect.

LOMOV. And your mother limped. (*He puts his hand over his heart*) Oh, my side pains! My temples are bursting! Lord in Heaven! Water!

TSCHUB. And your dear father was a gambler—and a glutton!

NATALIA. And your aunt was a gossip like few others!

LOMOV. And you are an intriguer. Oh, my heart! And it's an open secret that you cheated at the elections—my eyes are blurred! Where is my hat?

NATALIA. Oh, how low! Liar! Disgusting thing!

LOMOV. Where's the hat—? My heart! Where shall I go? Where is the door—? Oh—it seems—as though I were dying! I can't—my legs won't hold me—(*Goes to the door*)

TSCHUB. (*Following him*) May you never darken my door again!

NATALIA. Bring your suit to court! We'll see!

(*Lomov staggers out, center.*)

TSCHUB. (*Angrily*) The devil!

NATALIA. Such a good-for-nothing! And then they talk about being good neighbors!

TSCHUB. Loafer! Scarecrow! Monster!

NATALIA. A swindler like that takes over a piece of property that doesn't belong to him and then dares to argue about it!

TSCHUB. And to think that this fool dares to make a proposal of marriage!

NATALIA. What? A proposal of marriage?

TSCHUB. Why, yes! He came here to make you a proposal of marriage.

NATALIA. Why didn't you tell me that before?

TSCHUB. That's why he had on his evening clothes! The poor fool!

NATALIA. Proposal for me? Oh! (*Falls into an armchair and groans*) Bring him back! Bring him back!

TSCHUB. Bring whom back?

NATALIA. Faster, faster, I'm sinking! Bring him back! (*She becomes hysterical*)

TSCHUB. What is it? What's wrong with you? (*His hands to his head*) I'm cursed with bad luck! I'll shoot myself! I'll hang myself!

NATALIA. I'm dying! Bring him back!

TSCHUB. Bah! In a minute! Don't bawl! (*He rushes out, center*)

NATALIA. (*Groaning*) What have they done to me? Bring him back! Bring him back!

TSCHUB. (*Comes running in*) He's coming at once! The devil take him! Ugh! Talk to him yourself, I can't.

NATALIA. (*Groaning*) Bring him back!

TSCHUB. He's coming, I tell you! "Oh, Lord! What a task it is to be the father of a grown daughter!" I'll cut my throat! I really will cut my throat! We've argued with the fellow, insulted

him, and now we've thrown him out!—and you did it all, you!

NATALIA. No, you! You haven't any manners, you are brutal! If it weren't for you, he wouldn't have gone!

TSCHUB. Oh, yes, I'm to blame! If I shoot or hang myself, remember *you'll* be to blame. You forced me to it! You! (LOMOV *appears in the doorway*) There, talk to him yourself! (He goes out)

LOMOV. Terrible palpitation!— My leg is lamed! My side hurts me——

NATALIA. Pardon us, we were angry, Ivan Vasiliyitch. I remember now—the meadows really belong to you.

LOMOV. My heart is beating terribly! My meadows—my eyelids tremble—(They sit down) We were wrong. It was only the principle of the thing—the property isn't worth much to me, but the principle is worth a great deal.

NATALIA. Exactly, the principle! Let us talk about something else.

LOMOV. Because I have proofs that my aunt's grandmother had, with the peasants of your good father——

NATALIA. Enough, enough. (Aside) I don't know how to begin. (To LOMOV) Are you going hunting soon?

LOMOV. Yes, heath-cock shooting, respected Natalia Stepanovna. I expect to begin after the harvest. Oh, did you hear? My dog, Ugadi, you know him—limps!

NATALIA. What a shame! How did that happen?

LOMOV. I don't know. Perhaps it's a dislocation, or maybe he was bitten by some other dog. (He sighs) The best dog I ever had—to say nothing

of his price! I paid Mironov a hundred and twenty-five roubles for him.

NATALIA. That was too much to pay, Ivan Vasilivitch.

LOMOV. In my opinion it was very cheap. A wonderful dog!

NATALIA. Papa paid eighty-five roubles for his Otkatai, and Otkatai is much better than your Ugadi.

LOMOV. Really? Otkatai is better than Ugadi? What an idea! (*He laughs*) Otkatai better than Ugadi!

NATALIA. Of course he is better. It is true Otkatai is still young; he isn't full-grown yet, but in the pack or on the leash with two or three, there is no better than he, even——

LOMOV. I really beg your pardon, Natalia Stepanovna, but you quite overlooked the fact that he has a short lower jaw, and a dog with a short lower jaw can't snap.

NATALIA. Short lower jaw? That's the first time I ever heard that!

LOMOV. I assure you, his lower jaw is shorter than the upper.

NATALIA. Have you measured it?

LOMOV. I have measured it. He is good at running, though.

NATALIA. In the first place, our Otkatai is pure-bred, a full-blooded son of Sapragavas and Stame-skis, and as for your mongrel, nobody could ever figure out his pedigree; he's old and ugly, and as skinny as an old hag.

LOMOV. Old, certainly! I wouldn't take five of your Otkatais for him! Ugadi is a dog and Otkatai is—it is laughable to argue about it! Dogs like your Otkatai can be found by the dozens at any dog dealer's, a whole pound-full!



NATALIA. Ivan Vassiliyitch, you are very contrary to-day. First our meadows belong to you and then Ugadi is better than Otkatai. I don't like it when a person doesn't say what he really thinks. You know perfectly well that Otkatai is a hundred times better than your silly Ugadi. What makes you keep on saying he isn't?

LOMOV. I can see, Natalia Stepanovna, that you consider me either a blindman or a fool. But at least you may as well admit that Otkatai has a short lower jaw!

NATALIA. It isn't so!

LOMOV. Yes, a short lower jaw!

NATALIA. (*Loudly*) It's not so!

LOMOV. What makes you scream, my dear lady?

NATALIA. What makes you talk such nonsense? It's disgusting! It is high time that Ugadi was shot, and yet you compare him with Otkatai!

LOMOV. Pardon me, but I can't carry on this argument any longer. I have palpitation of the heart!

NATALIA. I have always noticed that the hunters who do the most talking know the least about hunting.

LOMOV. My dear lady, I beg of you to be still. My heart is bursting! (*He shouts*) Be still!

NATALIA. I won't be still until you admit that Otkatai is better!

(*Enter TSCHUBUKOV.*)

TSCHUB. Well has it begun again?

NATALIA. Papa, say frankly, on your honor, which dog is better: Otkatai or Ugadi?

LOMOV. Stepan Stepanovitch, I beg of you, just answer this: has your dog a short lower jaw or not? Yes or no?

TSCHUB. And what if he has? Is it of such im-

portance? There is no better dog in the whole country.

LOMOV. My Ugadi is better. Tell the truth, now!

TSCHUB. Don't get so excited, my dear fellow! Permit me. Your Ugadi certainly has his good points. He is from a good breed, has a good stride, strong haunches, and so forth. But the dog, if you really want to know it, has two faults; he is old and he has a short lower jaw.

LOMOV. Pardon me, I have palpitation of the heart!—Let us keep to facts—just remember in Maruskins's meadows, my Ugadi kept ear to ear with the Count Rasvachai and your dog.

TSCHUB. He was behind, because the Count struck him with his whip.

LOMOV. Quite right. All the other dogs were on the fox's scent, but Otkatai found it necessary to bite a sheep.

TSCHUB. That isn't so!—I am sensitive about that and beg you to stop this argument. He struck him because everybody looks on a strange dog of good blood with envy. Even you, sir, aren't free from the sin. No sooner do you find a dog better than Ugadi than you begin to—this, that—his, mine—and so forth! I remember distinctly.

LOMOV. I remember something, too!

TSCHUB. (*Mimicking him*) I remember something, too! What do you remember?

LOMOV. Palpitation! My leg is lame—I can't—

NATALIA. Palpitation! What kind of hunter are you? You ought to stay in the kitchen by the stove and wrestle with the potato peelings, and not go fox-hunting! Palpitation!

TSCHUB. And what kind of hunter are you? A man with your diseases ought to stay at home and not jolt around in the saddle. If you were a hun-

ter—! But you only ride round in order to find out about other people's dogs, and make trouble for everyone. I am sensitive! Let's drop the subject. Besides, you're no hunter.

LOMOV. And are you a hunter? You only ride around to flatter the Count!—My heart! You intriguer! Swindler!

TSCHUB. And what of it? (*Shouting*) Be still!

LOMOV. Intriguer!

TSCHUB. Baby! Puppy! Walking drug-store!

LOMOV. Old rat! Jesuit! Oh, I know you!

TSCHUB. Be still! Or I'll shoot you—with my worst gun, like a partridge! Fool! Loafer!

LOMOV. Everyone knows that—oh, my heart!—that your poor late wife beat you. My leg—my temples—Heavens—I'm dying—I—

TSCHUB. And your housekeeper wears the trousers in your house!

LOMOV. Here—here—there—there—my heart has burst! My shoulder is torn apart. Where is my shoulder? I'm dying! (*He falls into a chair*) The doctor! (*Faints*)

TSCHUB. Baby! Half-baked clam! Fool!

NATALIA. Nice sort of hunter you are! You can't even sit on a horse. (*To TSCHUB*) Papa, what's the matter with him? (*She screams*) Ivan Vassiliyitch! He is dead!

LOMOV. I'm ill! I can't breathe! Air!

NATALIA. He is dead! (*She shakes LOMOV in the chair*) Ivan Vassiliyitch! What have we done! He is dead! (*She sinks into a chair*) The doctor—doctor! (*She goes into hysterics*)

TSCHUB. Ahh! What is it? What's the matter with you?

NATALIA. (*Groaning*) He's dead!—Dead!

TSCHUB. Who is dead? Who? (*Looking at LOMOV*) Yes, he is dead! Good God! Water!

The doctor! (*Holding the glass to LOMOV's lips*) Drink! No, he won't drink! He's dead! What a terrible situation! Why didn't I shoot myself? Why have I never cut my throat? What am I waiting for now? Only give me a knife! Give me a pistol! (LOMOV *moves*) He's coming to! Drink some water—there!

LOMOV. Sparks! Mists! Where am I?

TSCHUB. Get married! Quick, and then go to the devil! She's willing! (*He joins the hands of LOMOV and NATALIA*) She's agreed! Only leave me in peace!

LOMOV. Wh—what? (*Getting up*) Whom?

TSCHUB. She's willing! Well? Kiss each other and—the devil take you both!

NATALIA. (*Groans*) He lives! Yes, yes, I'm willing!

TSCHUB. Kiss each other!

LOMOV. Eh? Whom? (NATALIA *and* LOMOV *kiss*) Very nice—! Pardon me, but what is this for? Oh, yes, I understand! My heart—sparks—I am happy, Natalia Stepanovna. (*He kisses her hand*) My leg is lame!

NATALIA. I'm happy, too!

TSCHUB. Ahh! A load off my shoulders! Ahh!

NATALIA. And now at least you'll admit that Ugadi is worse than Otkatai!

LOMOV. Better!

NATALIA. Worse!

TSCHUB. Now the domestic joys have begun.—Champagne!

LOMOV. Better!

NATALIA. Worse, worse, worse!

TSCHUB. (*Trying to drown them out*) Champagne, champagne!

CURTAIN

# Other Publications for Your Interest

---

## **A GALWAY GIRL**

(ALL GROUPS—DRAMA)

By GERALDINE ARON

1 man, 1 woman—Interior

A married couple, seated at opposite ends of a table, reminisce about their life together. Each presents the situation from his or her point of view, rarely addressing each other directly. The characters are young to begin with, then middle-aged, then old, then one of them dies. The anecdotes they relate are both humorous and tragic. Their lives seem wasted, yet at the end the wife's muted gesture of affection conveys the love that can endure through years of household bickering and incompatibility. A critical success in London, Ireland and the author's native South Africa. "A very remarkable play."—Times Literary Supplement, London. "A touching account of two wasted lives."—Daily Telegraph, London. "A minute tapestry cross-stitched with rich detail—invested with a strong strain of uncomfortable truths."—The Irish Times, Dublin.

---

## **TWO PART HARMONY**

(PLAY)

By KATHARINE LONG

1 man, 1 woman—Interior

A play about a confrontation of wits between an alert, pre-adolescent girl and a mentally unsettled child-man. On a spring morning in 1959, eight year old Jessie Corington, home alone on a sick day from school, receives an unexpected visit from Hank Everett, a former friend of the family who used to look like Bobby Darin. From the moment he arrives, Hank's eccentric behavior challenges Jessie's cherished belief in adult maturity. Gradually, however, she welcomes her new found playmate and becomes entranced as he enlists her aid in a telephone search for his estranged wife. As the play builds, their bond of friendship is almost shattered when the violence beneath Hank's innocence surfaces against his will. "The work of an artist skilled in deft, understated draughtmanship."—Village Voice.

---



# Other Publications for Your Interest

---

## VIVIEN

(COMIC DRAMA)

By PERCY GRANGER

2 men, 1 woman—Unit set

Recently staged to acclaim at Lincoln Center, this lovely piece is about a young stage director who visits his long-lost father in a nursing home and takes him to see a production of "The Seagull" that he staged. Along the way, each reveals a substantial truth about himself, and the journey eventually reaches its zenith in a restaurant after the performance. "A revealing father-son portrait that gives additional certification to the author's position as a very original playwright."—N.Y. Times "The dialogue has the accuracy of real people talking."—N.Y. Post.

---

## LANDSCAPE WITH WAITRESS

(COMEDY)

By ROBERT PINE

1 man, 1 woman—Interior

Arthur Granger is an unsuccessful novelist who lives a Walter Mitty-like fantasy existence. Tonight, he is dining out in an Italian restaurant which seems to have only one waitress and one customer—himself. As Arthur selects his dinner he has fantasies of romantic conquest, which he confides to the audience and to his notebook. While Arthur's fantasies take him into far-fetched plots, the waitress acts out the various characters in his fantasy. Soon, Arthur is chattering and dreaming away at such a quick clip that neither he nor we can be entirely sure of his sanity. Arthur finishes his dinner and goes home, ending as he began—as a lover *manqué*. "... a landscape of the mind."—Other Stages "... has moments of true originality and a bizarre sense of humor ... a devious and slightly demented half-hour of comedy."—N.Y. Times. Recently a hit at New York's excellent Ensemble Studio Theatre.

---

# Other Publications for Your Interest

---

## **MOVIE OF THE MONTH**

(COMEDY)

By DANIEL MELTZER

2 men—Interior

This new comedy by the author of the ever-popular *The Square Root of Love* is an amusing satire of commercial television. B.S., a TV programming executive, is anxious to bolster his network's ratings, which have been sagging of late due to programming disasters such as a documentary called "The Ugly Truth" (says B.S.: "What the hell is The Ugly Truth, and how the hell did it get into our Prime Time?") His eagerbeaver assistant, appropriately named Broun, has found a script which he is sure can be made into a hit "Movie of the Month". It's about this Danish prince, see, who comes home from college to find that his uncle has murdered his father and married his mother . . . Well, naturally, B.S. has his own ideas about how to fix such a totally unbelievable plot . . . (#17621)

---

## **SUNDANCE**

(ALL GROUPS—COMEDY)

By MEIR Z. RIBALOW

5 men—Simple interior

This new comedy from the author of *Shrunkn Heads* is set in a sort of metaphysical wild west saloon. The characters include Hickock, Jesse, the Kid, and the inevitable Barkeep. Hickock kills to uphold the law. Jesse kills for pleasure. The Kid kills to bring down The Establishment. What if, wonders the Barkeep, they met up with the Ultimate Killer—who kills for no reason, who kills simply because that's what he does? Enter Sundance. He does not kill to uphold the law, for pleasure, or to make a political statement, or because he had a deprived childhood. And he proceeds to kill everyone, exiting at the end with his sixguns blazing! "Witty, strong, precise, unusually well-written."—*The Guardian*. "A brilliant piece."—*Dublin Evening Press*. This co-winner of the 1981 Annual NYC Metropolitan Short Play Festival has been a success in 6 countries! (#3113)

---

---

**HOME-BUILT**

*Lighting Equipment*  
**for The Small Stage**  
By THEODORE FUCHS

This volume presents a series of fourteen simplified designs for building various types of stage lighting and control equipment, with but one purpose in mind—to enable the amateur producer to acquire a complete set of stage lighting equipment at the lowest possible cost. The volume is 8½" x 11" in size, with heavy paper and spiral binding—features which make the volume well suited to practical workshop use.

*Community Theatre*  
**A MANUAL FOR SUCCESS**  
By JOHN WRAY YOUNG

The ideal text for anyone interested in participating in Community Theatre as a vocation or avocation. "Organizing a Community Theatre," "A Flight Plan for the Early Years," "Programming for People—Not Computers," and other chapters are blueprints for solid growth. "Technical, Business and Legal Procedures" cuts a safe and solvent path through some tricky undergrowth. Essential to the library of all community theatres, and to the schools who will supply them with talent in the years to come.

---

SAMUEL FRENCH, INC.

APPROACHING LAVENDAR—AUTO-EROTIC  
MISADVENTURE—BOX OFFICE—BUSINESSMAN'S  
LUNCH—BUT NOT FOR ME—A CHANGE FROM  
ROUTINE—CHEKHOV—CLOSET MADNESS—  
CO-INCIDENCE—CROSSING THE BAR—THE DEVIL—  
THE DICKS—THE DIVORCE—THE DOLPHIN  
POSITION—DOSTOEVSKI—DREAMBOATS—  
THE ENCHANTED MESA—FATHER AND SON—  
FINE LINE—FORBIDDEN FRUIT—THE GIFT—GOD'S  
SPIES—GOOD HELP IS HARD TO FIND—HERE  
TO STAY—LAST CHANCE TEXACO—A LITTLE  
SOMETHING FOR THE DUCKS—THE NECKLACE—  
NOW DEPARTING—PASTORAL—PIECE FOR AN  
AUDITION—P IS FOR PERFECT—THE RABBI AND  
THE TOYOTA DEALER—RECEPTION—A SCENT  
OF HONEYSUCKLE—SOMETHING TO EAT—  
A TANTALIZING—THAT PIG MORIN—THURSDAY  
IS MY DAY FOR CLEANING—WHAT WOULD  
JEANNE MOREAU DO?

Consult our *Basic Catalogue of Plays* for details.





# THE SAMUEL FRENCH THEATER BOOKSHOP

Specializing in plays and  
books on the theater

ISBN 0 573 62898 X

## **SAMUEL FRENCH, INC. (New York)**

45 West 25th Street  
New York, NY 10010-2751  
(212) 206-8990 (FAX 212-206-1429)  
(open 9:00-5:00, Mon.-Fri.)

## **SAMUEL FRENCH, INC. (California)**

7623 Sunset Blvd 11963 Ventura Blvd.  
Hollywood, CA 90048-2795 Studio City, CA 91604  
(323) 878-0570 (818) 762-0535  
FAX 323-878-6822

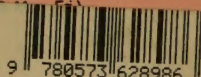
(call for hours)

## **SAMUEL FRENCH, (Canada) LTD.**

100 Lombard Street  
Toronto, Ontario M5C 1M3  
CANADA  
(416) 363-3536  
(open 9:00-5:00, Mon.-Fri.)

## **SAMUEL FRENCH LTD. (England)**

52 Fitzroy Street  
London W1P 6JR  
England  
(open 9:30-5:30, Mon.-Fri.)



9 780573 628986

978-0-573-62898-6

MARRIAGE PROPOSAL

860

The DRAMA BOOK SHOP

\*P7-AVH-298\*

